

Women in Ministry Leadership

Overview

The Foursquare Church is now, and has been since its founding, a movement submitted to the authority of Scripture. Our first article of faith unmistakably places the Bible as the foundation of all we believe signifying clearly that we consider the Word of God to be the final authority in all matters of faith and practice. The topic of women in ministry leadership is not an exception to this value. We are proud of our history and deeply respect our founder, Aimee Semple McPherson. We are grateful that she invested her gifts and talents in establishing a denomination that would outlast her, but our commitment to the topic of women in ministry leadership is not based on our history or our respect for our founder. It is based on the conviction that the Word of God requires us to include women as equal partners in ministry with men. Our position is a matter of obedience, not compromise, and the *Women in Ministry Leadership* Booklet provides further commentary through relevant Bible passages.

The Foursquare Global Council has also engaged in intentionally promoting women in leadership ministry. In 2012, it adopted Foursquare's six Global Distinctives (Foursquare Identity #1), one of which states: "Empowering Leadership Culture: According to God's gifting and calling, we will intentionally prepare and release men and women across generations and cultures into all positions of leadership and areas of ministry." Foursquare also identified its value and belief that women should be celebrated and equipped for every area of ministry leadership by claiming Women in Senior Leadership as an Identity Keystone (Foursquare Identity #2).

The Foursquare Church believes when women and men stand side by side, serving Jesus and His mission, the image of God is seen through this blessed alliance.

The Foursquare Women in Ministry Leadership booklet provides further reading on Foursquare position statements, a Biblical basis for Foursquare's stance, and a history of Foursquare women leaders.

Interview Questions

- Have you read the booklet, *Women in Ministry Leadership*?
- Supporting your answer with scripture, what is your understanding of Foursquare's position on WIML?
- Do you align with this understanding and how will you practice it?

Pastoral Considerations/Application

- We want pastors who value the partnership of women and men leading together.
- We want ministers who wholeheartedly equip and champion women in any leadership capacity.